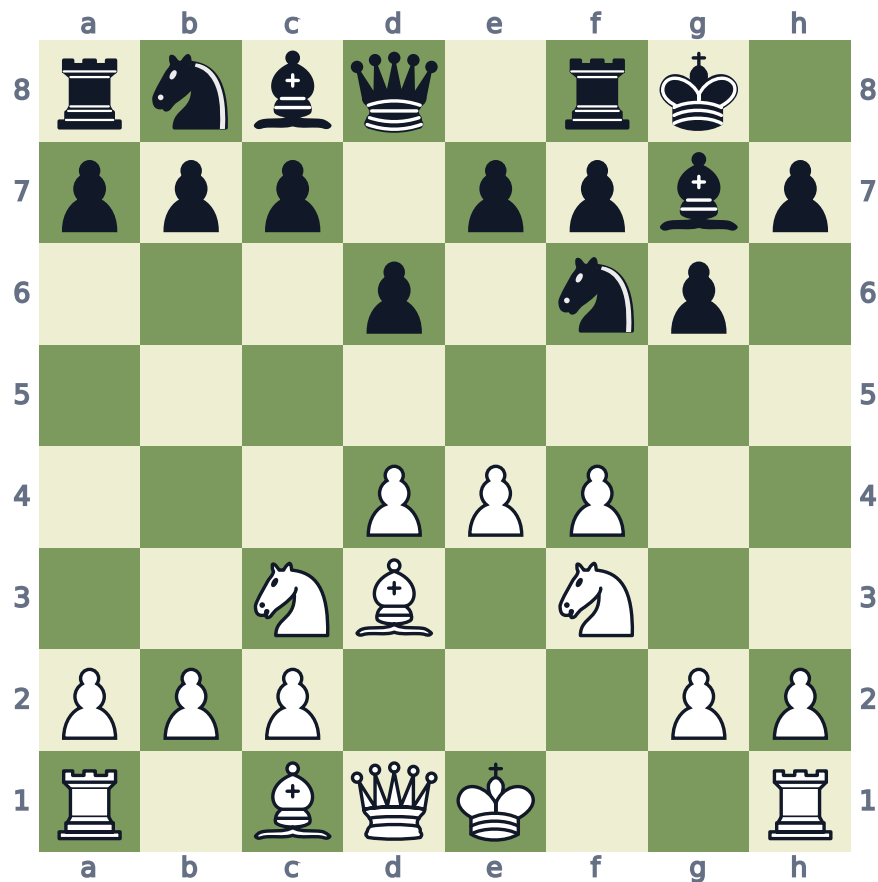


Pirc and Modern Defense Repertoire

The Austrian Attack, broad centers, f4, Black's c5 and e5 challenges, and delayed development



Build the Austrian center with f4 while respecting Black's hypermodern counterattack against e4 and d4.

8 learning units | diagrams | recall tests | engine-checked analysis

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Build the Austrian center with f4 while respecting Black's hypermodern counterattack against e4 and d4.

THE TRAINING LOOP

- First identify Black's defense from pawn placement and move order.
- At every diagram, name the center, the urgent threat, and two candidate moves.
- Hide the recall answer until you have spoken the move and its purpose.
- Replay each line from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 8 units inside a connected White repertoire. It covers the main structural and move-order decisions you need for practical play; the PGN companion makes later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

Black allows the center, then attacks it with pieces and pawn breaks.

PRINCIPLE 2

f4 gains space but loosens e3 and the king.

PRINCIPLE 3

Nf3, Bd3, and castling must support the center before expansion.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

Black's ...c5 and ...e5 are the main challenges.

PRINCIPLE 5

The Modern can delay ...Nf6 and choose a different attack on d4.

PRINCIPLE 6

Do not confuse space with a permanent advantage.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 1-8

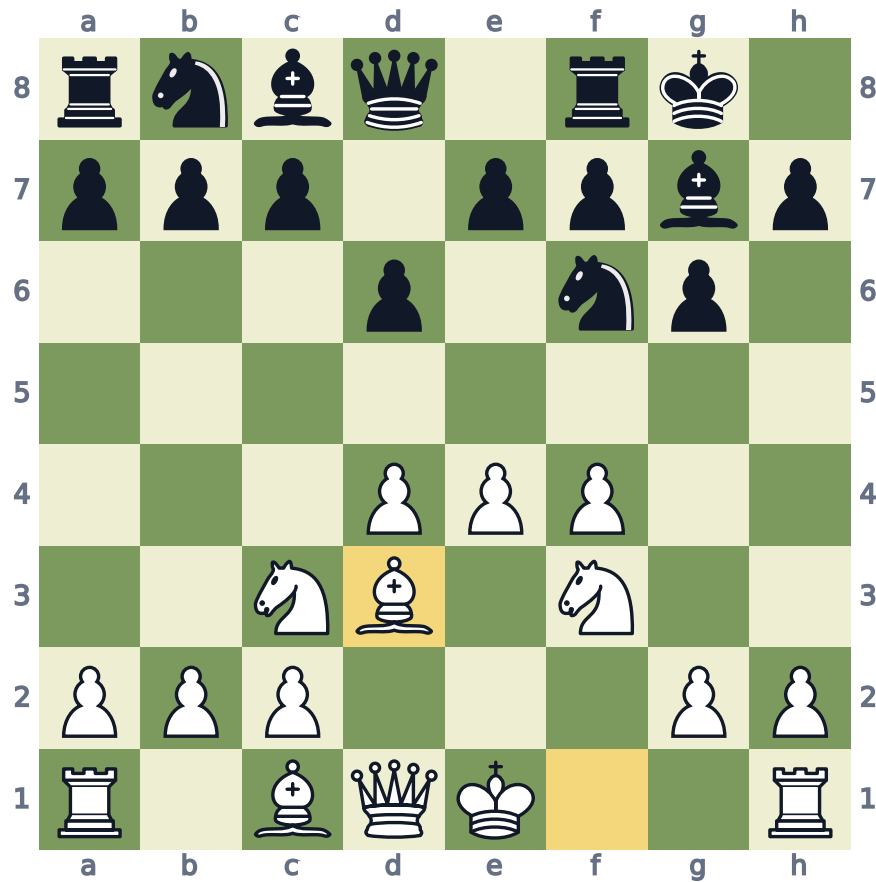
- | | | |
|-----------|-------------------------------|---|
| 01 | Austrian Attack core | f4 is useful because pieces are coming quickly behind it. |
| 02 | Pirc ...c5 | Against ...c5, choose between d5, dxc5, and e5 by concrete calculation. |
| 03 | Pirc ...Na6 | ...Na6 often supports ...c5 or ...e5 without blocking the c-pawn. |
| 04 | Pirc ...Nc6 | ...Nc6 increases pressure on d4 and e5. |
| 05 | Modern ...c6 and ...b5 | When Black expands on the wing, central action is the principled reply. |
| 06 | Modern ...a6 | ...a6 and ...b5 spend tempi; ask whether the center can open. |
| 07 | Czech Pirc | ...c6 and ...Qa5 create direct pressure rather than a fianchetto. |
| 08 | Rat Defense | Against ...f5, calculate the central opening and return material if needed. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 01

Austrian Attack core



COURSE LINE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. f4 Bg7 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Bd3

WHITE'S IDEA

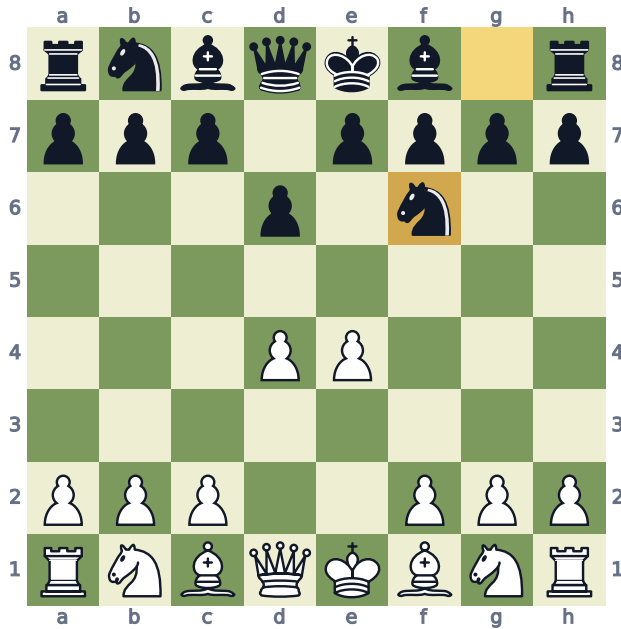
Build the broad center, develop, and prepare e5 or castling.

MAIN DANGER

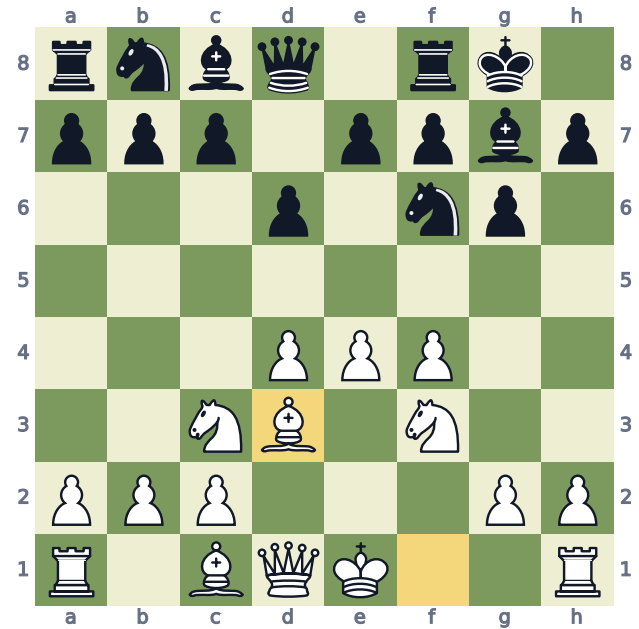
The center can be struck by ...c5 or ...e5 before White is ready.

BRANCH LOGIC 01

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

f4 is useful because pieces are coming quickly behind it.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.68 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nc6 O-O 2. Bg4 e5 3. Bxf3 Rxf3 4. dxe5 dxe5 5. Nd5 Qe1

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 01

Austrian Attack core



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 02

Pirc ...c5



COURSE LINE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. f4 Bg7 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Bd3 c5 7. d5

WHITE'S IDEA

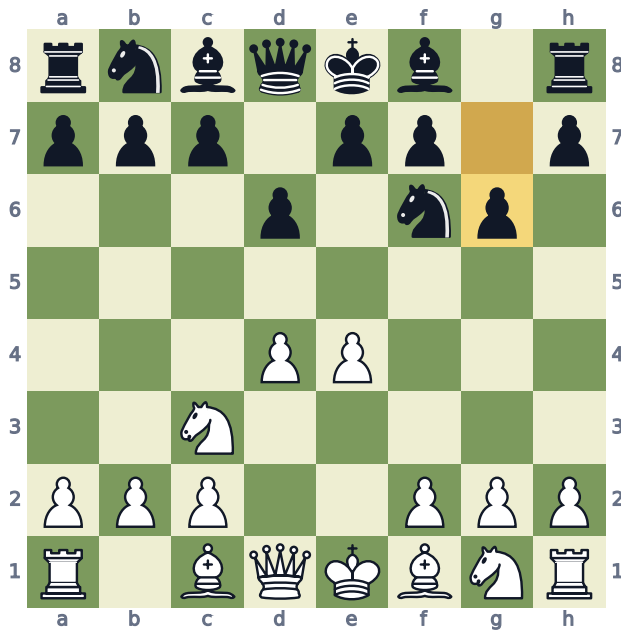
Gain space and prepare e5 while Black attacks the center from the flank.

MAIN DANGER

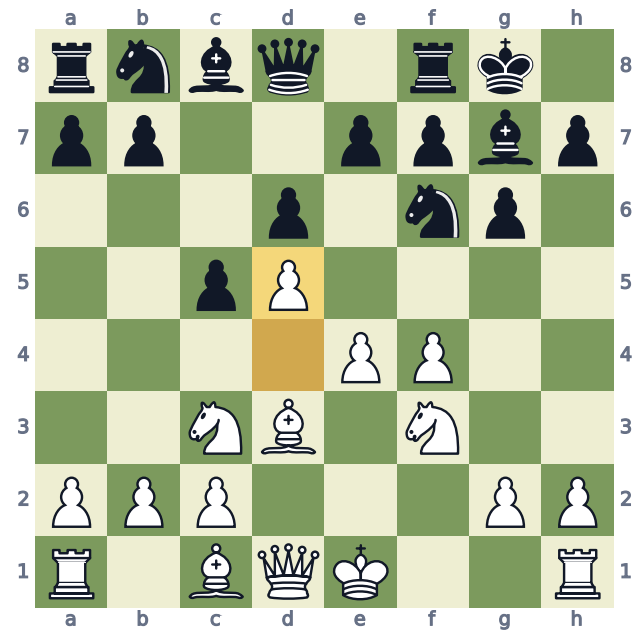
Closing with d5 can give Black b5 and e6 breaks.

BRANCH LOGIC 02

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Against ...c5, choose between d5, dxc5, and e5 by concrete calculation.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

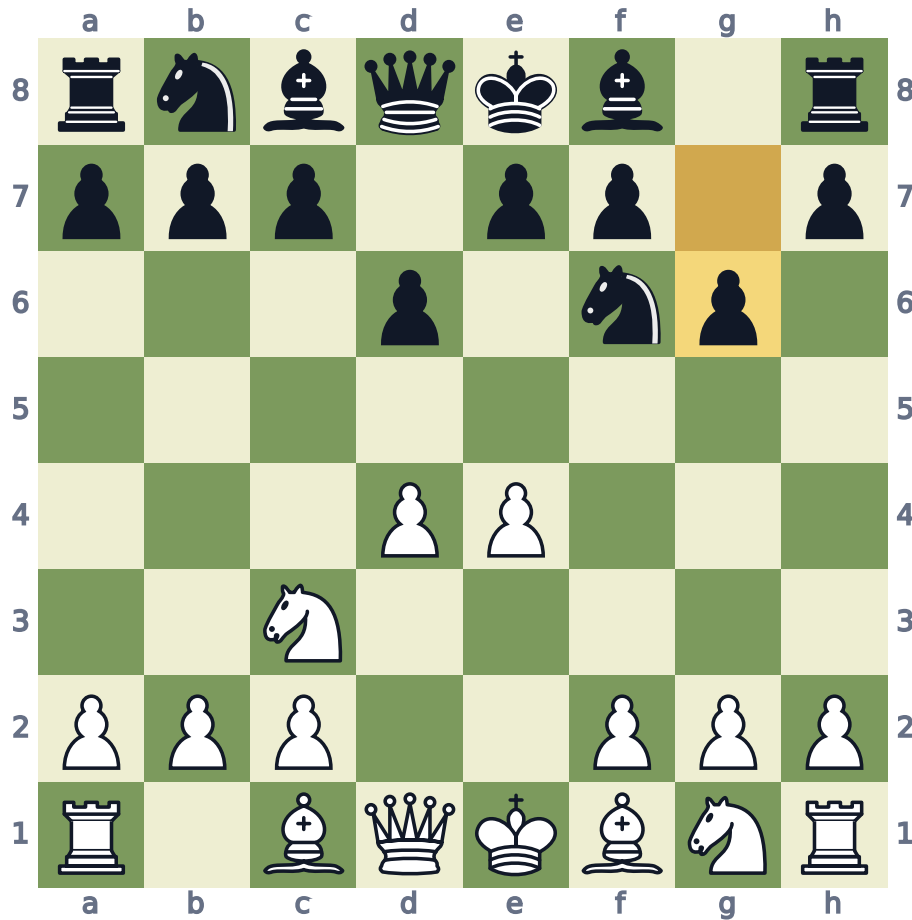
Position estimate: +0.65 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. c4 Bxc4 2. b5 Nxb5 3. Nxe4 a4 4. a6 Nbd4 5. Nf6 O-O

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 02

Pirc ...c5



YOUR TASK

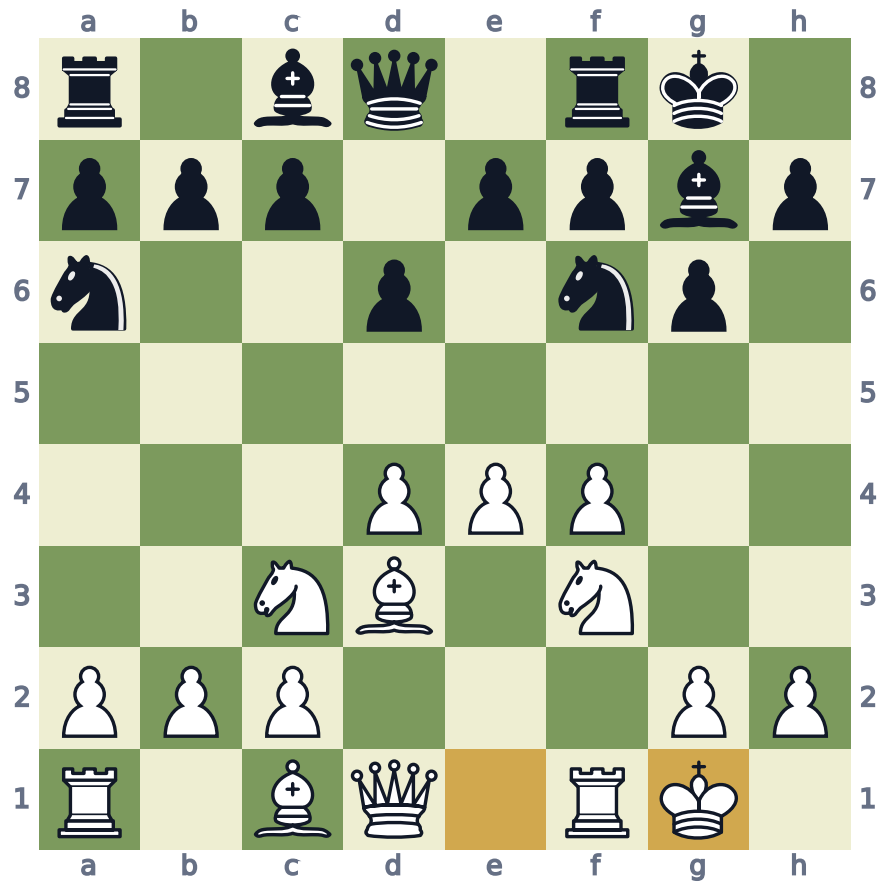
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 03

Pirc ...Na6



COURSE LINE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. f4 Bg7 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Bd3 Na6 7. O-O

WHITE'S IDEA

Castle and keep the center flexible while Black reroutes the knight.

MAIN DANGER

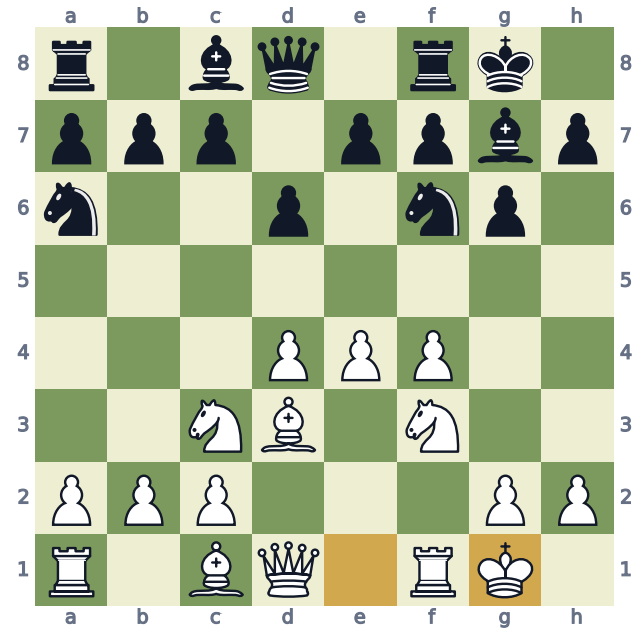
Black may play ...c5 and ...Nb4 against Bd3.

BRANCH LOGIC 03

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...Na6 often supports ...c5 or ...e5 without blocking the c-pawn.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

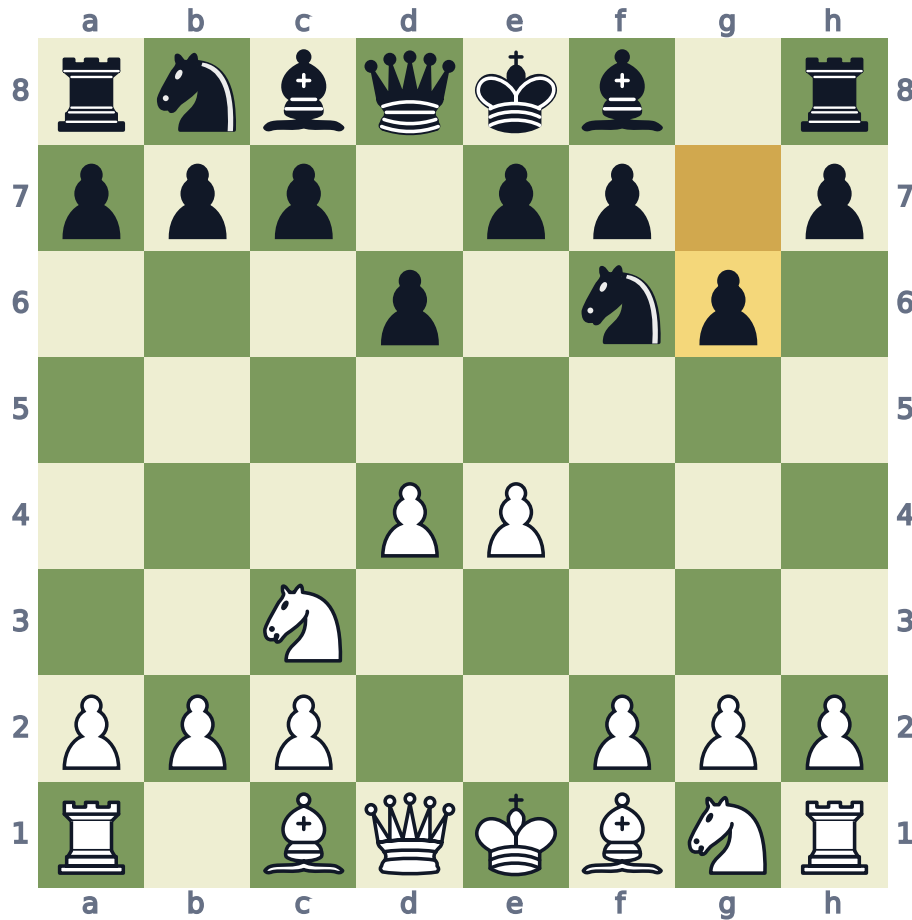
Position estimate: +0.84 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bg4 h3 2. Bxf3 Rxf3 3. Nd7 Be2 4. c5 d5 5. Rc8

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 03

Pirc ...Na6



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 04

Pirc ...Nc6



COURSE LINE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 g6 4. f4 Bg7 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be3 Nc6

WHITE'S IDEA

Develop and prepare Qd2 or e5 while controlling d5.

MAIN DANGER

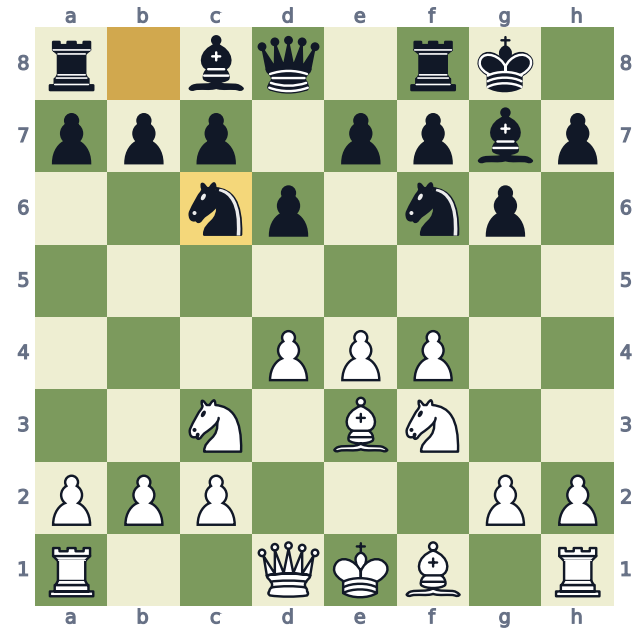
e5 can be met by ...dxe5 and tactics on the queen.

BRANCH LOGIC 04

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...Nc6 increases pressure on d4 and e5.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

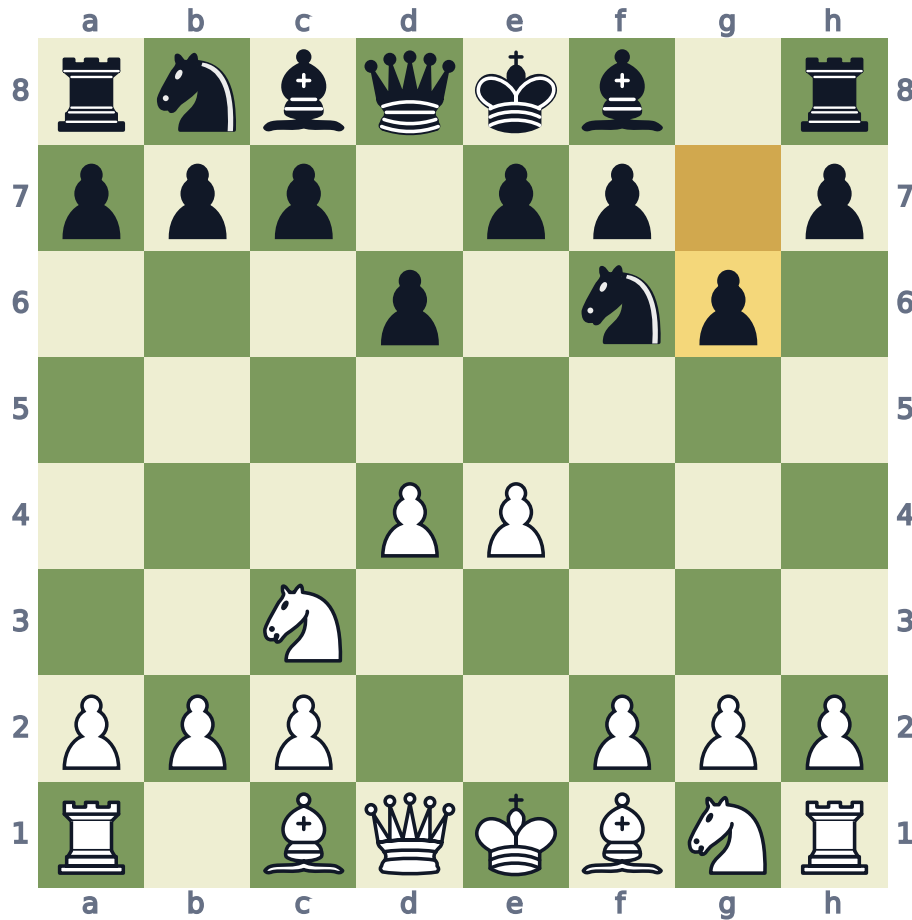
Position estimate: +0.70 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Be2 Bg4 2. d5 Nb8 3. h3 Bxf3 4. Bxf3 c6 5. O-O cxd5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 04

Pirc ...Nc6



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 05

Modern ...c6 and ...b5



COURSE LINE

1. e4 g6 2. d4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. f4 c6 5. Nf3 b5

WHITE'S IDEA

Develop and strike in the center before Black's queenside expansion becomes useful.

MAIN DANGER

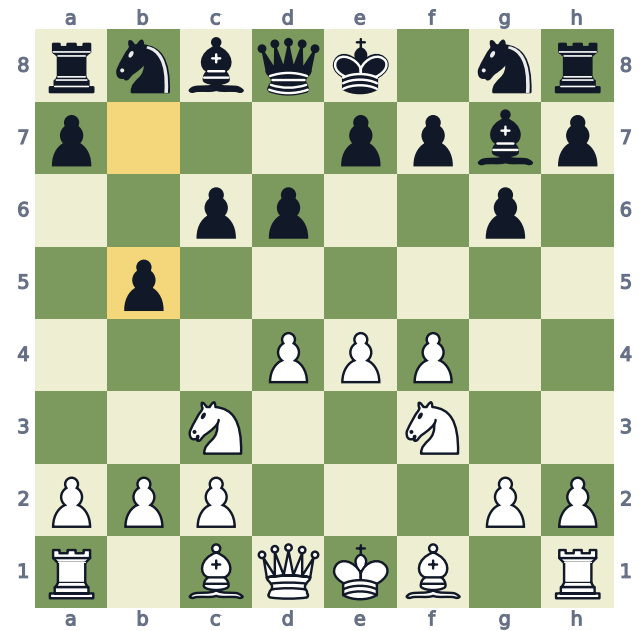
Ignoring ...b4 can dislodge the c3 knight and weaken e4.

BRANCH LOGIC 05

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

When Black expands on the wing, central action is the principled reply.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

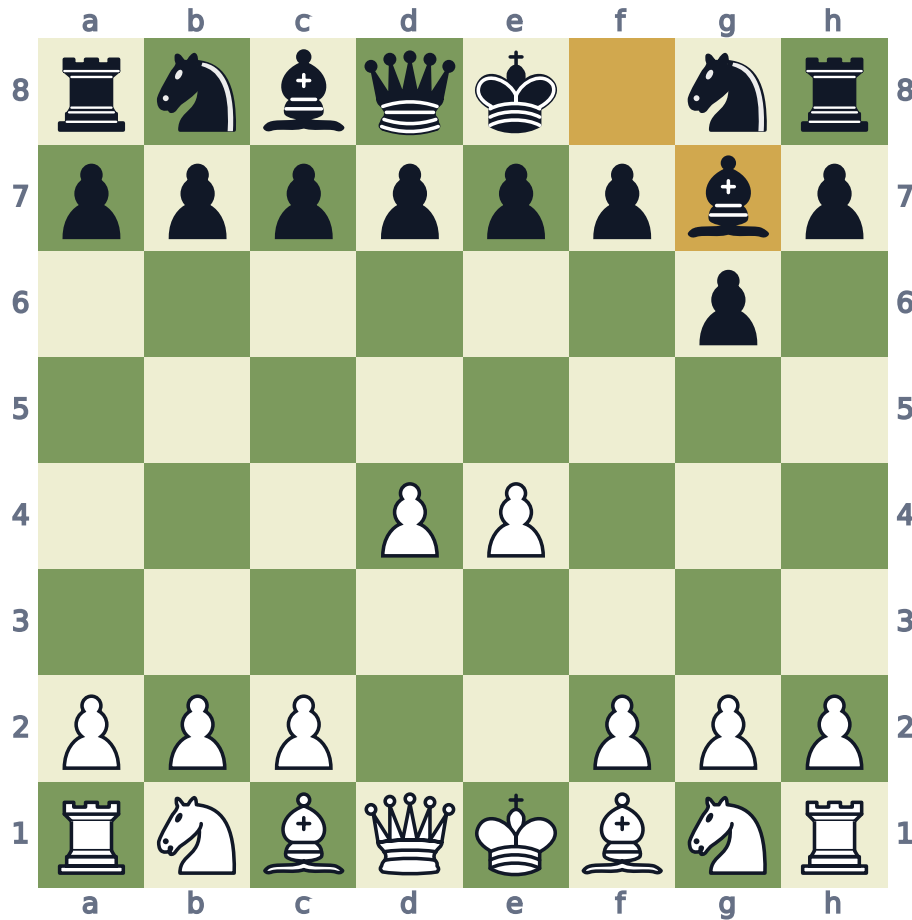
Position estimate: +1.20 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bd3 Nd7 2. O-O b4 3. Ne2 Ngf6 4. a3 bxa3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 05

Modern ...c6 and ...b5



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 06

Modern ...a6



COURSE LINE

1. e4 g6 2. d4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. f4 a6 5. Nf3 b5

WHITE'S IDEA

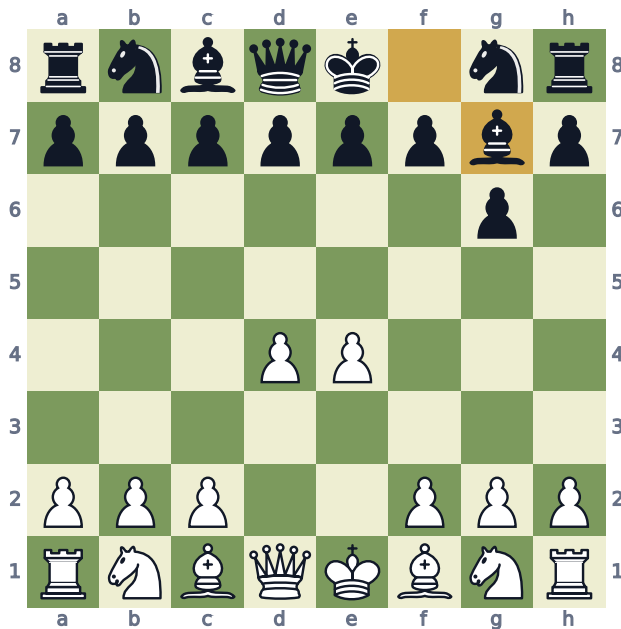
Use rapid development and consider e5 before Black completes queenside play.

MAIN DANGER

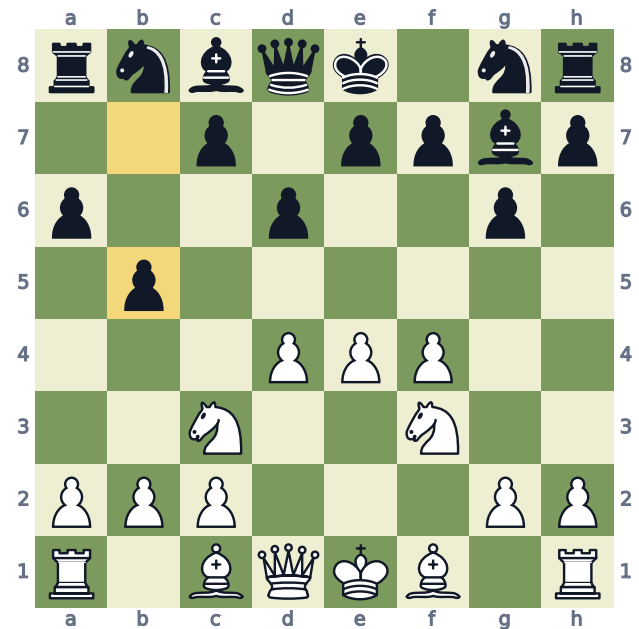
A premature e5 can leave d4 weak.

BRANCH LOGIC 06

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...a6 and ...b5 spend tempi; ask whether the center can open.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

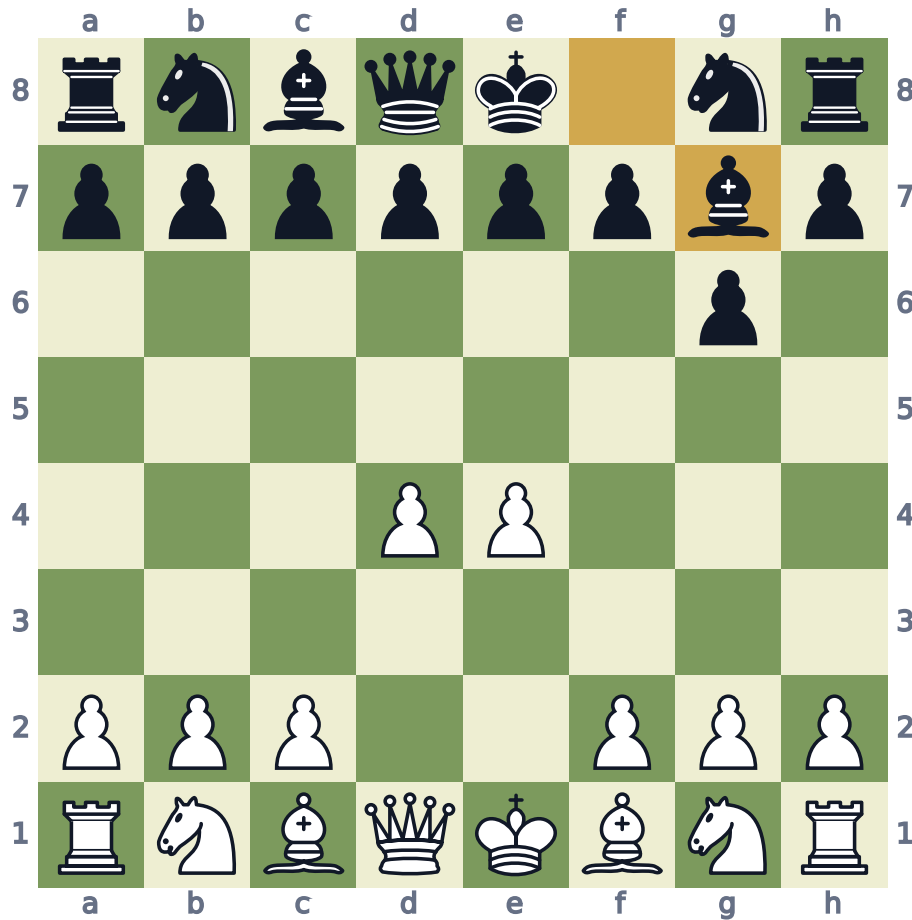
Position estimate: +0.67 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bd3 Bb7 2. O-O Nd7 3. e5 Nh6 4. a4 b4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 06

Modern ...a6



YOUR TASK

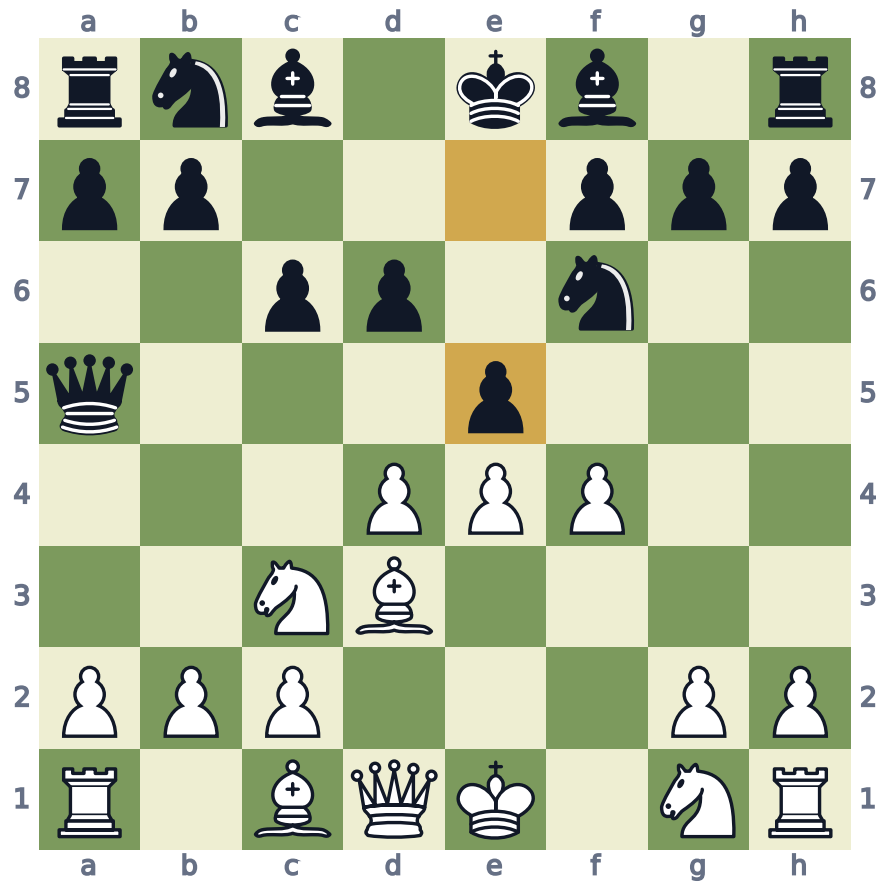
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 07

Czech Pirc



COURSE LINE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 Nf6 3. Nc3 c6 4. f4 Qa5 5. Bd3 e5

WHITE'S IDEA

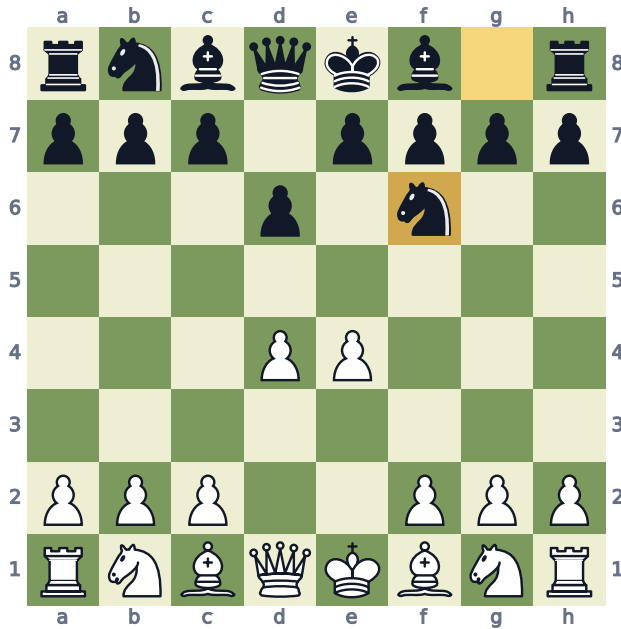
Support the center and meet the queen pressure with development.

MAIN DANGER

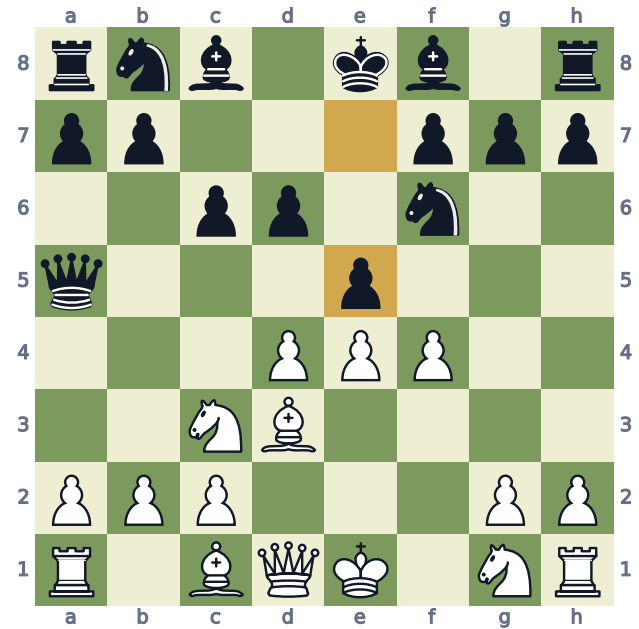
The e4 pawn and c3 knight can be attacked together.

BRANCH LOGIC 07

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...c6 and ...Qa5 create direct pressure rather than a fianchetto.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.95 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nf3 exd4 2. Nxd4 g6 3. Be3 Bg7 4. h3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 07

Czech Pirc



YOUR TASK

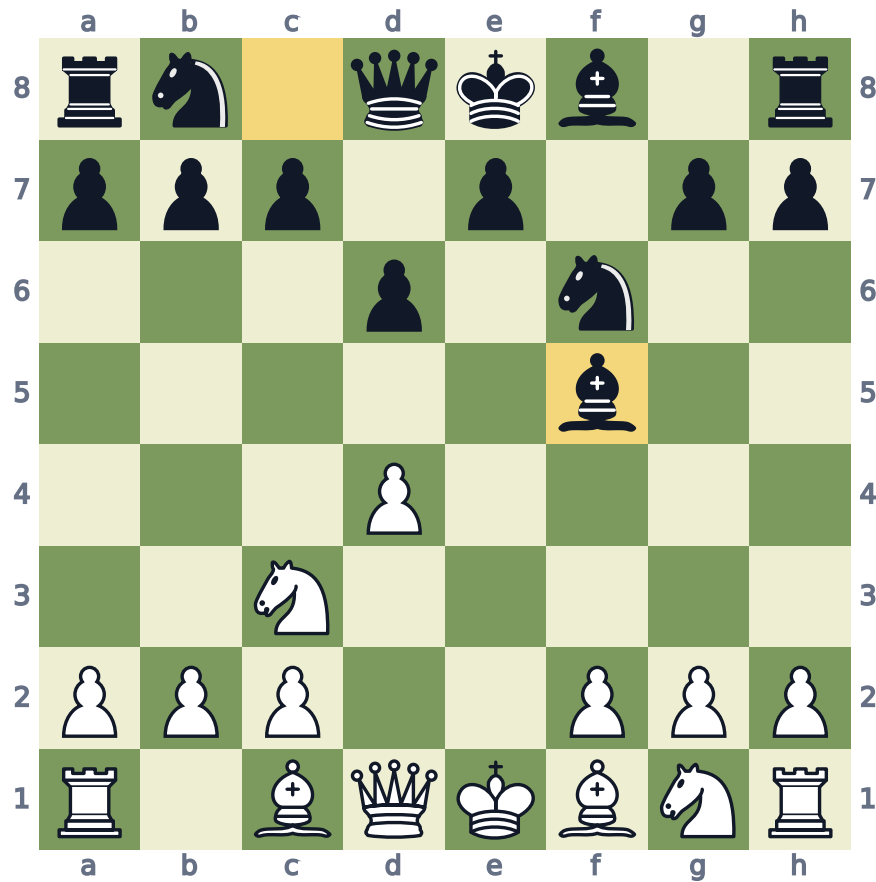
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 08

Rat Defense



COURSE LINE

1. e4 d6 2. d4 f5 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. exf5 Bxf5

WHITE'S IDEA

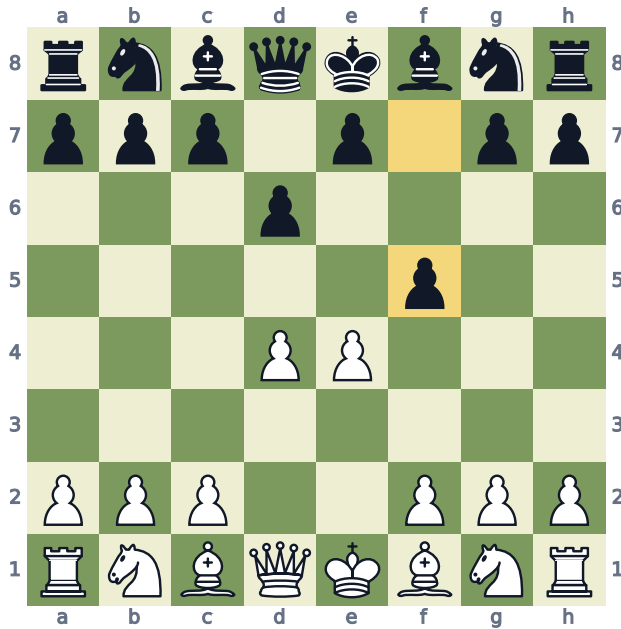
Open the center while Black's king and e6 square are weakened.

MAIN DANGER

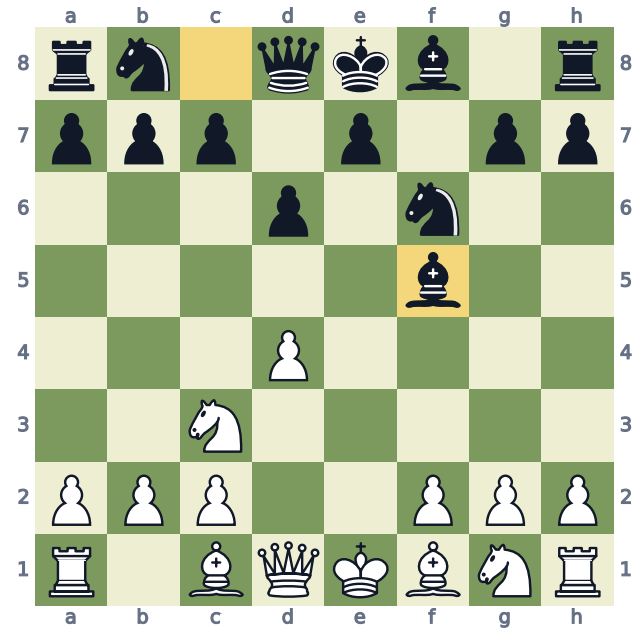
Holding the pawn can fall behind in development.

BRANCH LOGIC 08

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Against ...f5, calculate the central opening and return material if needed.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

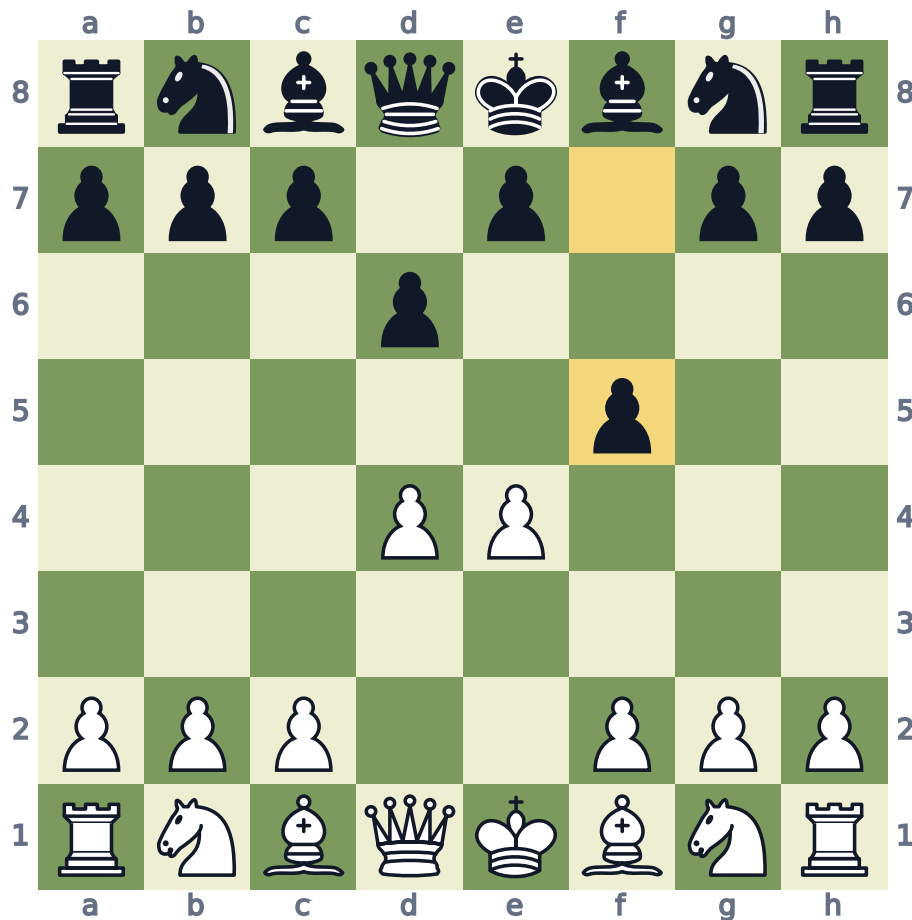
Position estimate: +0.97 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bg5 e6 2. Bd3 Bxd3 3. Qxd3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 08

Rat Defense



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Recall solutions begin here

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not read a solution until you have committed to a move and purpose. A matching move without the correct reason earns partial credit. If the course move is not the engine's first choice, compare plans rather than treating the engine as a memorization oracle.

ERROR LABELS

M = move-order memory | T = tactical oversight | P = plan misunderstanding | V = visualization | C = calculation | R = rushed recognition

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce a question you can use in future games. Example: 'When Black supports d5 with c6, which pawn break or recovery method does my repertoire use?'

SOLUTIONS

Answers 1-3

01. AUSTRIAN ATTACK CORE

Course move: Nc3. Purpose: Build the broad center, develop, and prepare e5 or castling. Engine comparison: 1. Nc3 e5 2. Nf3 Nbd7 3. a4 Be7 4. a5 O-O 5. Be2 exd4 (+0.49 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The center can be struck by ...c5 or ...e5 before White is ready.

02. PIRC ...C5

Course move: f4. Purpose: Gain space and prepare e5 while Black attacks the center from the flank. Engine comparison: 1. Be3 c6 2. Bd3 Bg7 3. h3 O-O 4. a4 Re8 5. Qd2 Nbd7 (+0.71 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Closing with d5 can give Black b5 and e6 breaks.

03. PIRC ...NA6

Course move: f4. Purpose: Castle and keep the center flexible while Black reroutes the knight. Engine comparison: 1. Be3 c6 2. Bd3 Bg7 3. h3 O-O 4. a4 Re8 5. Qd2 Nbd7 (+0.71 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Black may play ...c5 and ...Nb4 against Bd3.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 4-6

04. PIRC ...NC6

Course move: f4. Purpose: Develop and prepare Qd2 or e5 while controlling d5. Engine comparison: 1. Be3 c6 2. Bd3 Bg7 3. h3 O-O 4. a4 Re8 5. Qd2 Nbd7 (+0.71 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: e5 can be met by ...dxe5 and tactics on the queen.

05. MODERN ...C6 AND ...B5

Course move: Nc3. Purpose: Develop and strike in the center before Black's queenside expansion becomes useful. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 d6 2. h3 Nf6 3. Nc3 O-O 4. Be3 e5 5. dxe5 dxe5 (+0.65 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Ignoring ...b4 can dislodge the c3 knight and weaken e4.

06. MODERN ...A6

Course move: Nc3. Purpose: Use rapid development and consider e5 before Black completes queenside play. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 d6 2. h3 Nf6 3. Nc3 O-O 4. Be3 e5 5. dxe5 dxe5 (+0.65 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: A premature e5 can leave d4 weak.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 7-8

07. CZECH PIRC

Course move: Nc3. Purpose: Support the center and meet the queen pressure with development. Engine comparison: 1. Nc3 e5 2. Nf3 Nbd7 3. a4 Be7 4. a5 O-O 5. Be2 exd4 (+0.49 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The e4 pawn and c3 knight can be attacked together.

08. RAT DEFENSE

Course move: Nc3. Purpose: Open the center while Black's king and e6 square are weakened. Engine comparison: 1. Nc3 Nf6 2. Bd3 fxe4 3. Nxe4 Nxe4 4. Bxe4 g6 5. c3 Nd7 (+1.18 for White (White is clearly better)). Warning: Holding the pawn can fall behind in development.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.